

# Product Requirements Document

## DoneHo

*An Adaptive Scheduling Engine for the Indian Lifestyle*

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Related: DoneHo Product Case Study (Strategy, UX & Growth Analytics)

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# 1. Overview & Problem Statement

## 1.1 Summary

DoneHo is a mobile scheduling application built for the structural unpredictability of Indian daily life — power cuts, multigenerational households, unpredictable commutes, and caregiving demands that routinely break rigid, Western-style calendar tools.

Instead of treating a missed task as a failure (red “overdue” markers, guilt-driven notifications), DoneHo treats disruption as the expected default and designs the entire product around recovery. The core interaction — the “Life Happened” button — lets a user signal a disruption in one tap and receive an AI-generated recalibrated plan within seconds.

## 1.2 Problem Statement

Mainstream productivity tools (Google Calendar, Outlook, Todoist) assume environmental control: a fixed commute, a quiet workspace, predictable hours. For roughly 85% of India's working population, none of these assumptions hold consistently.

Three core failure modes drive abandonment of existing tools:

- The Compliance Paradox — missed tasks are punished visually (red “overdue” text), producing guilt rather than a path forward.
- Contextual Blindness — a high-traffic commute and a deep-work session are treated as structurally identical; no concept of energy depletion.
- Decision Fatigue in Crisis — when a plan breaks mid-day, manually rebuilding it is cognitively expensive enough that most users abandon planning altogether.

Together these create the Guilt-Spiral: a missed task triggers a negative notification, which triggers avoidance of the app, which compounds the backlog, ending in abandonment.

## 1.3 Objective

Build an adaptive scheduling product whose primary value proposition is recovery, not compliance — validated by a Sean Ellis PMF score of 52% (new mothers) and 48% (exam aspirants) “very disappointed if unavailable,” both above the 40% PMF benchmark.

## 2. Goals & Success Metrics

### 2.1 North Star Metric

Weekly Healed High-Value Tasks (WHHT) — the count of Anchor or Steady tasks completed successfully after a Life Happened disruption was triggered. WHHT was chosen over simpler proxies (total tasks completed, DAU) because it isolates the specific moment of value realization: not that the user opened the app, but that the app helped them recover something that mattered.

### 2.2 Supporting Input Metrics

| Input Metric      | Category      | Target       | Why It Matters                                                     |
|-------------------|---------------|--------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Recovery Velocity | Efficiency    | < 15 seconds | Minimizes abandonment during a high-stress moment                  |
| Vault Utilization | Feature Depth | > 60%        | Confirms the Vault functions as a safety net, not a dumping ground |
| Resilience Growth | Engagement    | +10% MoM     | Tracks formation of the long-term “pivot” habit                    |

### 2.3 Business Goals

- Reach 40% Day-7 retention within the Q1 MVP window.
- Achieve Day-30 retention of 45% by end of Beta phase.
- Validate freemium-to-paid conversion via Pro (₹149/mo) and Circles (₹399/mo) tiers.

### 2.4 Non-Goals (v1)

- Family/multi-user sync across households — deferred due to technical complexity.
- Wearable integration for energy-sync — deferred to Q3.
- Fully autonomous AI rescheduling without user approval — explicit “approve” step is retained by design to preserve user agency.

## 3. Target Users & Personas

### 3.1 Market Sizing

| Market Layer | Size        | Definition                                                                                     |
|--------------|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| TAM          | ~700M users | All Indian smartphone users facing scheduling friction                                         |
| SAM          | ~150M users | Urban/semi-urban English & Hindi speakers (Tier 1–2 cities) open to digital productivity tools |
| SOM (Year 1) | ~5M users   | “Resilient Achievers”: working mothers, competitive-exam aspirants, gig-economy users          |

The Year 1 target (SOM) represents roughly 3.3% of SAM. Starting with the highest-disruption-frequency personas is deliberate: a system that works under maximum chaos generalizes to lower-volatility users — the reverse is not true.

### 3.2 Primary Personas

| Persona | Context                                           | Primary Friction                                                                   | DoneHo Response                                                                       |
|---------|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Priya   | 28, new mother & engineering student, Bengaluru   | Career goals deprioritized against infant care — the “guilt spiral”                | Saturday Vault auto-moves missed study blocks to a protected weekend slot             |
| Sandeep | 23, UPSC aspirant, Patna (joint family household) | 12-hour study targets broken by power cuts and domestic interruptions              | Auto-Heal compresses a 2-hour block into a higher-intensity 90-minute session         |
| Meera   | 34, freelance designer & single parent, Mumbai    | Decision fatigue — too many competing priorities by late afternoon                 | Smart Tray pre-sequences tasks by energy level so no in-the-moment decision is needed |
| Ankit   | 30, senior tech associate, Gurugram               | All-or-nothing thinking — one disrupted meeting cancels the rest of the day's plan | Resilience Score reframes a partial day as a successful adaptation, not a failure     |

Across personas, the shared root cause is environmental volatility outside the user's control, not a lack of discipline. The product treats unpredictability as a normal input rather than an edge case.

## 4. Solution Overview

DoneHo reframes the core unit of planning from “tasks on a calendar” to “energy and risk allocation across a volatile day.” Four mechanisms carry this idea end-to-end:

### 4.1 Adaptive Timeline

A vertical feed that separates Steady tasks (non-negotiable — meetings, feeding times) from Volatile tasks (flexible — study blocks, errands). Volatile blocks compress or shift automatically as Steady tasks expand.

### 4.2 Life Happened Trigger

A single, persistent floating action button (FAB). On tap, the system presents three recovery paths:

- Compress — shrink the remaining day to fit everything
- Vault — move the task to the weekend buffer
- Sacrifice — drop low-priority items to protect Anchor goals

### 4.3 Saturday Vault

A dedicated overflow space for deferred tasks, with notifications suppressed until the weekend — converting “unfinished work” from a source of anxiety into a scheduled, bounded review.

### 4.4 Resilience Score (Phase 3)

A gamified weekly metric that rewards successful adaptation to disruption rather than raw task-completion rate — reinforcing the philosophy that recovery, not perfection, is the win condition.

*“The biggest risk for DoneHo is feature creep. By limiting the MVP to the recovery loop, the product focuses entirely on a single emotional outcome: the moment a user realizes they don’t have to feel guilty for being human.”*

## 5. Functional Requirements

| Requirement           | Description                                                                                            | Acceptance Criteria                                                                    |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Adaptive Timeline     | Vertical feed distinguishing Steady Anchors from Volatile Blocks; Volatile blocks resize automatically | Volatile blocks visually compress/expand within 1.5s of an Anchor change               |
| Life Happened Trigger | Persistent FAB; on tap, pauses the active task and presents three recovery paths                       | Recovery options rendered within 1.5s of tap; user can select and confirm in under 10s |
| Saturday Vault        | Secondary workspace for deferred tasks with notifications suppressed until Saturday 9 AM               | Vaulted tasks do not trigger any notification before the unlock time                   |
| Resource Tray         | Context-aware content injection (e.g., a relevant video or doc surfaced inside a task block)           | Tray content matches the task category with no manual search required                  |
| Resilience Score      | Weekly gamified score rewarding successful adaptation over raw completion                              | Score recalculates within 24h of week-end and is visible on the home dashboard         |



## 6. Non-Functional Requirements

### 6.1 Performance

- Latency: Auto-Heal recalculation must complete in under 1.5 seconds — a loading state during a crisis undermines the product's core promise.

### 6.2 Privacy & Architecture

- Device-local processing: scheduling logic runs on-device (edge computing) for both speed and to avoid uploading sensitive domestic-routine data to the cloud.

### 6.3 Accessibility

- Primary interaction targets (Life Happened, task completion) sit in the bottom third of the screen for one-handed use — directly informed by caregiver research.

### 6.4 Visual Design

- A muted, non-alarming color palette is used deliberately instead of the red “overdue” conventions of competitor apps, to avoid reinforcing the guilt response the product is designed to remove.

## 7. MVP Scope & Prioritization

The backlog was prioritized using the MoSCoW framework, with every “Must Have” item audited against a single question: does this feature directly reduce guilt or decision fatigue? Features that did not pass this test were deferred regardless of how “delightful” they appeared.

| Category        | Features                                                 | Rationale                                                                                                         |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Must Have       | Adaptive Timeline, Life Happened Trigger, Saturday Vault | Together these form the complete recovery loop — without all three, the product is functionally a static calendar |
| Should Have     | Smart Tray content, Resilience Score                     | Strengthens the “companion” feel and reinforces long-term habit formation                                         |
| Could Have      | Dark mode, voice-to-action input                         | Improves accessibility and aesthetic distinction but does not affect the core loop                                |
| Won't Have (v1) | Family/multi-user sync, wearable integration             | High technical complexity; deferred to protect the core launch timeline                                           |

### 7.1 Walking Skeleton (MVP Validation Slice)

To validate the core hypothesis with minimum build effort, the MVP is scoped as a single end-to-end slice:

1. Anchor Setup
2. Adaptive Timeline
3. Life Happened Trigger
4. Saturday Vault

Success is defined not by feature completeness but by whether a user reports reduced anxiety after completing one full recovery cycle.

## 8. Key User Flows

### 8.1 Onboarding → Anchor Setup

5. User selects a Life-Stage Template (e.g., UPSC Aspirant, New Parent) to seed initial defaults.
6. User defines Steady Anchors (fixed commitments) for the week.
7. System generates the initial Adaptive Timeline.

### 8.2 Disruption → Recovery (Core Loop)

8. User taps the Life Happened FAB when a disruption occurs.
9. System presents three recovery options: Compress, Vault, Sacrifice.
10. User selects and approves a recalibrated plan (explicit approval required — Auto-Heal is not fully autonomous).
11. Timeline updates within 1.5 seconds; vaulted items move to the Saturday Vault with notifications suppressed.

### 8.3 Weekly Review → Saturday Vault

12. Vault unlocks Saturday 9 AM; suppressed notifications surface.
13. User reviews deferred tasks and reschedules, drops, or commits them.
14. Resilience Score updates based on the week's recovery activity.

## 9. Analytics Framework

### 9.1 HEART Framework

| Category     | Goal                                                       | Key Metric                                                               |
|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Happiness    | Users feel supported, not judged, after a disruption       | Average satisfaction score (1–5) on post-pivot survey                    |
| Engagement   | Active, repeated use of adaptive features                  | Pivots per daily active user                                             |
| Adoption     | Fast setup of initial Life Anchors                         | % of users completing 3+ anchors on Day 1                                |
| Retention    | Users return after a disrupted week rather than churning   | Vault-to-active return rate (Monday return after Saturday Vault session) |
| Task Success | Users recover their day quickly with minimal manual effort | Mean time to recovery (MTTR)                                             |

### 9.2 AARRR Growth Funnel

| Stage       | DoneHo Mechanism                                                                                                            | Primary Metric                 |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Acquisition | Targeted outreach to niche communities experiencing high planning-related stress (exam-prep groups, new-parent communities) | CAC                            |
| Activation  | First Life Happened interaction within 48 hours of signup                                                                   | Activation rate                |
| Retention   | Saturday Vault functions as a weekly re-engagement loop                                                                     | Day-30 retention (target: 45%) |
| Referral    | Users share a weekly “Resilience Report” summarizing disruptions handled                                                    | Viral coefficient (K-factor)   |
| Revenue     | Freemium upgrade to unlimited Vault slots and Smart Tray content                                                            | MRR, ARPU                      |

### 9.3 PMF Validation (Sean Ellis Test)

| Segment                   | % “Very Disappointed” | Industry Benchmark |
|---------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------|
| New mothers               | 52%                   | 40%                |
| Students / exam aspirants | 48%                   | 40%                |

Both segments exceeded the 40% benchmark commonly used as an early PMF signal, with the Life Happened button cited most frequently as the primary source of relief.

## 10. Competitive Landscape

| Dimension             | Google Calendar / Outlook | Todoist / Any.do          | DoneHo                      |
|-----------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Core Logic            | Rigid time-blocking       | Static list-making        | Fluid adaptive timeline     |
| Failure Mode          | Red “Overdue” text        | Tasks pile up as past-due | Auto-Heal / Strategic Pivot |
| Underlying Philosophy | Compliance-based          | Discipline-based          | Resilience-based            |

DoneHo does not compete on feature parity with global productivity tools — it competes on a different definition of success. The differentiation is contextual intelligence: accounting for the realities of a multigenerational Indian household rather than assuming a Western, single-occupant, deep-work environment.

## 11. Monetization & Go-to-Market

### 11.1 Pricing Model

| Tier     | Price             | Target Segment                  | Key Features                                                       |
|----------|-------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Freemium | ₹0 (free)         | Casual users, students          | Unlimited Life Happened triggers; 3 Vault slots/week               |
| Pro      | ₹149/mo           | Exam aspirants, working parents | Unlimited Vaulting, Smart Tray content, energy-sync with wearables |
| Circles  | ₹399/mo (5 users) | Families, study groups          | Shared Life Anchors across household members                       |

### 11.2 Go-to-Market Phasing

| Phase | Timeline   | Target         | Approach                                                                                   |
|-------|------------|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Alpha | Months 1–2 | 1,000 users    | Invite-only beta with UPSC aspirant and new-parent communities in Bengaluru                |
| Beta  | Months 3–5 | 50,000 users   | Influencer-led campaigns on Instagram and LinkedIn within the productivity/parenting niche |
| Scale | Month 6+   | 500,000+ users | Partnerships with EdTech platforms and corporate maternity-return wellness programs        |

### 11.3 Distribution: WhatsApp Integration

Given WhatsApp's near-universal presence in Indian households, a lightweight integration allows users to message “Life Happened” directly to a DoneHo bot, which returns a link to the recalibrated schedule — reducing the friction of opening a separate app during a moment of stress.

## 12. Roadmap (12-Month View)

| Quarter | Theme                | Focus                                                                                                                                        |
|---------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Q1      | The Resilient MVP    | Core recovery loop — Adaptive Timeline, manual Life Happened trigger, Saturday Vault. Target: 40% Day-7 retention.                           |
| Q2      | Context & Content    | Life-Anchor presets (e.g., C-section recovery, UPSC prep) and initial Resilience Score gamification; on-device AI for instant recalculation. |
| Q3      | The Connected Engine | Wearable energy-sync and real-time traffic/power-alert APIs to pre-emptively trigger Auto-Heal.                                              |
| Q4      | Predictive Mastery   | AI-suggested predictive buffers based on a user's historical disruption patterns.                                                            |

### 12.1 Prioritization Logic

Each roadmap item was scored using a simplified Cost-of-Delay (WSJF) approach. The Saturday Vault, for example, scored above wearable integration despite being simpler to build, because its time-criticality — preventing immediate user churn after a bad week — outweighed the larger job size of hardware syncing.

## 13. Risks & Mitigations

| Risk                                                                                                | Mitigation                                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Cold start: the system needs 7–14 days of usage data to predict a user's energy patterns accurately | Pre-populated “Life-Stage Templates” (e.g., UPSC Aspirant, New Parent) provide reasonable defaults from Day 1                                                         |
| Platform encroachment: Google/Apple could add similar “flexible mode” features to native calendars  | DoneHo's differentiation is emotional design (the recovery framing and Saturday Vault), not a feature that can be copied without rethinking the underlying philosophy |
| AI fatigue: users may perceive frequent recalibration suggestions as another nagging notification   | A guardrail metric (“Ignored Suggestions”) detects when a user is disengaging from Auto-Heal and triggers a simplification prompt rather than more suggestions        |



## 14. Open Questions & Dependencies

- Figma high-fidelity prototype link to be finalized and attached to this PRD.
- Confirm on-device AI model footprint and battery impact for Auto-Heal recalculation on low-end Android devices (a significant share of the SAM).
- Define exact instrumentation plan for the “Ignored Suggestions” guardrail metric ahead of Q1 launch — flagged as the highest-priority follow-up.
- WhatsApp Business API integration scope and cost for the Life Happened bot distribution channel.
- Legal/compliance review for on-device storage of domestic-routine data under India's data protection regulations.

## 15. Appendix: Design Process Notes

Design followed an Empathize → Define → Ideate → Prototype → Test process:

- Empathize: Observational research with caregivers found that standard push notifications during high-stress moments (e.g., a crying infant) were perceived as additional stressors rather than helpful reminders.
- Define: The problem was reframed from “How do we help users manage time better?” to “How do we help users recover their daily goals without the emotional cost of a broken schedule?” A working constraint was set: re-planning a full day must take under 5 seconds of user interaction.
- Ideate: Over 50 candidate features were filtered through an Impact-vs-Feasibility lens. The Saturday Vault was selected as the highest-leverage idea — a middle path between deleting a task (which feels like failure) and snoozing it indefinitely (which causes clutter).
- Prototype: Low-fidelity testing confirmed the Life Happened button needed to sit bottom-center for one-handed, thumb-reachable access — critical for users multitasking with childcare.
- Test: In small-scale usability testing, users reported feeling more in control using Auto-Heal versus manual rescheduling. Auto-Heal could not be fully autonomous — users needed an explicit “approve” step to retain agency over their own day.

*End of Document*